André

She read it one more time, savoring every word. *Berlin. Tempelhof Airport. French POWs. Beautiful and Brave.* And then her favorite part: *if you could come here*. All this time, she'd worried he would reject her like the French soldiers had done at the canteen, accusing her of being a collaborator. But he understood.

"What does he say?" Léa asked.

"He's in Berlin at the Tempelhof Airport with other French POWs assembling Stuka dive bombers," she said, realizing that he hadn't mentioned their love for one another and hoped that meant he was being careful not to let others know their secret.

"I'm happy you found him," said her sister, smiling. To be honest, I didn't think it was possible. You and he are meant to be together."

"He said he isn't allowed to move around freely the way we are but he can visit the city if he applies for a day pass. He wants me to come see him." She turned to Léa. "Can I travel to Berlin?"

"You'll have to apply, and if your record is clear, they will grant you permission. I don't see any reason why they wouldn't allow it."

"Come with me, please!"

"If you'd like me to, yes, I will." She squeezed Rose's hand. "A trip to Berlin to see André! Now you have something to look forward to." Léa squatted alongside her sister. "It's your turn—you said you have something important to tell me."

Rose lowered her eyes. "It's not something I'm proud of. I hope you won't hate me."

"Of course I won't hate you. What's happened?"

"I met someone a few months ago. After my shift ended, I went to the church to draw because it was quiet and warm inside. I noticed a pile of candles and decided to take a few—"

"You stole them? Were you caught?"

"No. But a man approached me and well, I talked to him. Anguish was etched all over his face. He'd just received news that his brother had died in battle."

"Who is this man?"

The name was seared in Rose's mind, the harsh K scratching like a saw